



Vaibhav Chhabra from Makers Asylum

steam, it gave rise to the empire that is now Maker Media that consequently started Maker Faire, a flagship carnival of and for makers. And so it came to be that the maker movement was born. That, or the story was completely hogwash but in any case, the term seems to be here to stay.

Whether the maker movement is making a dent in the American economy can perhaps be explained through statistics; in 2013, Shapeways set up 13,500 online storefronts, Etsy sold a total merchandise of \$1.35 billion from 1 million active shops. The figures are part of

the Impact of the maker movement report by Deloitte centre. The most impressive of this litany of numbers however is one titbit that tells us how Facebook acquired Oculus Rift for \$2 billion. This isn't impressive, of course, till you realise that the Oculus Rift took off as a Kickstarter offering where it managed to crowdfund \$2.4 million.

But why are makerspaces which function as a hot mess of innovation relevant to established industries? "Those organisations/individuals who fail to embrace the coming waves of open innovation, open source hardware and software and truly cross disciplinary collaboration are going to die out. At the same time, the Maker Movement will live up to its currently hyped expectations only when it finds a sustainable way to convert ideas into refined, ready for market products and services, and in the process create valuable IP," says Shah.

Closer to home, it is meaningful to know how and why the maker movement is going to make waves. Currently, there are around 20 makerspaces in India, most of whom aren't more than three years old. Maker's Asylum is joined by Curiosity Gym and Riidl in Mumbai, Nuts and Boltz in Delhi, Collab House and Potential Labs in Hyderabad, Workbench Projects, The Workshop and Eden in Bangalore, and Maker Loft in Kolkata. Moreover, companies are investing their R&D budgets into internal innovation hubs which function much like makerspaces minus the access to general public.